Imagine you work for a mid-sized company that runs a blog to attract new software and operations engineers and uses WordPress as the content management system. Around 1,000 people visit the blog daily. You are paying $250 per month for the on-premises infrastructure. This seems expensive to you, particularly because at the moment, the blog suffers from several outages per month.

To leave a good impression on potential candidates, the infrastructure should be highly available, which is defined as an uptime of 99.99%. Therefore, you are evaluating new options to operate WordPress reliably. AWS seems to be a good fit. As a proof of concept, you want to evaluate whether a migration is possible, so you need to do the following:

- Set up a highly available infrastructure for WordPress.
- Estimate the monthly costs of the infrastructure.
- Come to a decision and delete the infrastructure afterward.

WordPress is written in PHP and uses a MySQL database to store data. Besides that, data like user uploads is stored on disk. Apache is used as the web server to serve the pages. With this information in mind, it’s time to map your requirements to AWS services.

2.1 Creating your infrastructure

You’ll use the following five AWS services to copy the old infrastructure to AWS: